

PHASE 6 – PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Final Report

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Field	Details
Team ID	6ab4c536b5170a9b58b4c6e7
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

This project, “Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer,” implements a ServiceNow workflow for Standard Laptop requests. An employee selects Standard Laptop under Service Catalog → Hardware. For an approved Standard Laptop request, the configured Standard Laptop Task Flow creates a Catalog Task using the Requested Item Record and assigns it to Hardware for configuration.

1.2 Purpose

The purpose is to streamline IT procurement by reducing manual intervention between request approval and laptop configuration. The project focuses on workflow automation rather than changing the underlying laptop procurement policy.

2. IDEATION PHASE

2.1 Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

The requester wants a simple and timely laptop fulfillment process. Pain points include manual task creation, configuration delays and repeated follow-up. The desired gains are fast request handling, automatic task creation and correct Hardware assignment.

2.3 Brainstorming

Ideas covered request automation, approval automation, task automation, Hardware assignment, notifications, inventory integration, SLA monitoring and dashboards. The selected idea was to automate Standard Laptop Orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Customer Journey Map

Employee need → Service Catalog request → Approval → Flow execution → Catalog Task → Hardware configuration.

3.2 Solution Requirement

FR-01: Standard Laptop under Service Catalog → Hardware

FR-02: Service Catalog trigger

FR-03: System User execution

FR-04: Requested Item Record

FR-05: Create Catalog Task after approval

FR-06: Short description = Laptop need to Configured

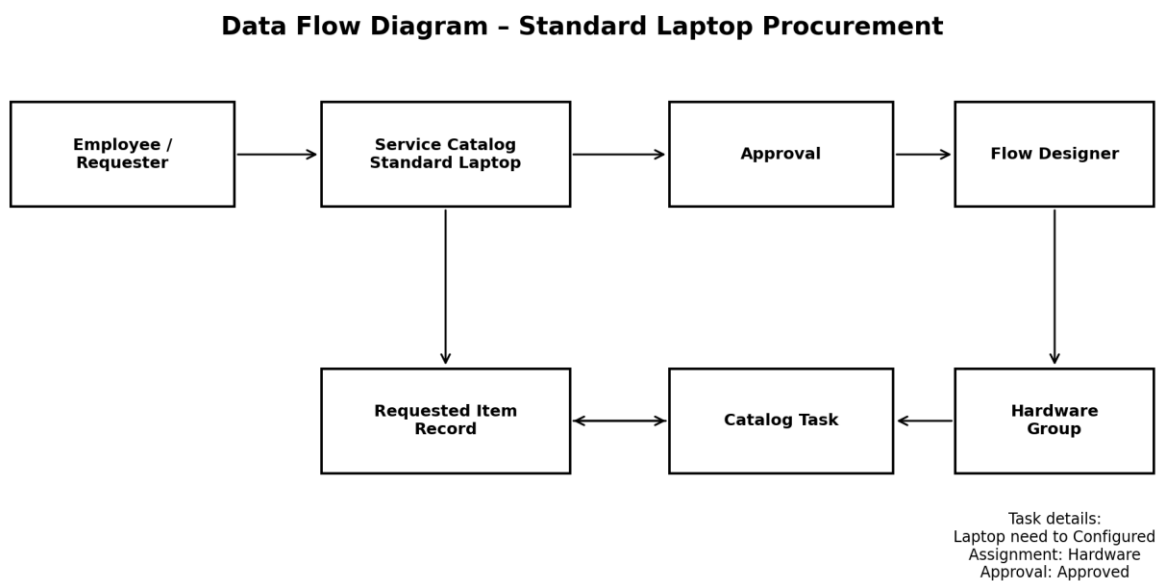
FR-07: Description = Laptop need to Configured

FR-08: Assignment Group = Hardware

FR-09: Approval = Approved

FR-10: Task visible from Requested Item → Catalog Tasks

3.3 Data Flow Diagram



Data Flow: Employee → Service Catalog → Approval → Flow Designer → Requested Item → Catalog Task → Hardware

3.4 Technology Stack

ServiceNow platform; Service Catalog; Flow Designer; Service Catalog Trigger; ServiceNow Approval; Create Catalog Task; Catalog Task; Hardware Assignment Group; System User; Global application scope.

4. PROJECT DESIGN

4.1 Problem Solution Fit

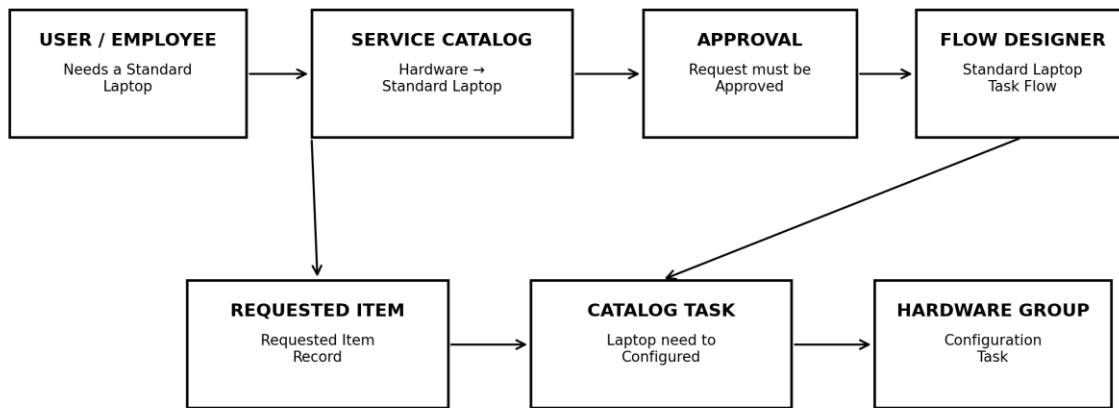
Automation directly addresses manual task creation, possible configuration delays, task assignment overhead and inefficient resource allocation.

4.2 Proposed Solution

Use the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item and a Flow Designer automation that creates/assigns the configuration Catalog Task for the approved request process.

4.3 Solution Architecture

Solution Architecture - Automated Standard Laptop Procurement



Core automation: Approved Service Catalog request → Flow Designer → Create Catalog Task → Hardware assignment

Solution Architecture

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

The planning sequence is: understand problem → define requirements → design solution → create Flow → assign Flow → test request → approve → verify Catalog Task → document results.

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

Parameter	Method	Acceptance Condition	Actual
Flow execution	Inspect execution	Successful completion	To be recorded
Task creation	Observe trigger-to-task availability	No unnecessary delay	To be recorded
Repeated requests	Run multiple valid tests if permitted	Each valid request creates intended task	To be recorded
Assignment reliability	Inspect generated tasks	Hardware selected consistently	To be recorded

Testing results must be populated from actual ServiceNow execution; no unobserved result is assumed.

7. RESULTS

7.1 Output Screenshots

UAT EVIDENCE 1 – Flow Designer – Standard Laptop Task

Workflow Studio

New Flow
Flow • None

Let's get the details for your flow

Flow name *

Application *

Description

▼ Hide additional properties

Protection

Run as

Flow priority default

UAT EVIDENCE 2 – Service Catalog trigger

Workflow Studio

Standard laptop task
Flow • Global

Standard laptop task Inactive

View:

TRIGGER

Trigger

ACTIONS

Select multiple

ERROR HANDLER

☐ If an error occurs in your f

Data

- Flow Variables
- Trigger

Status: Draft | Application: Global

UAT EVIDENCE 3 – Create Catalog Task configuration

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Workflow Studio interface for configuring a 'Standard laptop task'. The trigger is set to 'Service Catalog'. The action is 'Create Catalog Task'. The action inputs are configured as follows:

- Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]
- * Requested Item (Requested Item): Drag and drop Requested Item pill
- Short Description: [Empty field]
- Fields: + Add field value
- Wait: ☒
- Template Catalog Item (Catalog Item): Select Template Catalog Item
- Catalog Variables: Available: Select Template Catalog Item, Selected: Create Catalog Item(s) that

The right sidebar shows the 'Data' section with the following variables:

- Flow Variables
- Trigger - Service Catalog
 - Requested Item Record
 - Run Start Time UTC
 - Run Start Date/Time
 - Table Name
- 1 - Create Catalog Task

Status: Draft | Application: Global

UAT EVIDENCE 4 – Standard Laptop Process Engine / Flow assignment

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Catalog Item configuration page for 'Standard Laptop'. The configuration is as follows:

- Name: Standard Laptop
- Application: Global
- Active: ☒
- Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified
- Category: Hardware
- State: -- None --
- Checked out: -- None --
- Owner: [Empty field]

The 'Process Engine' tab is selected, showing the following configuration:

- Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.
- Flow: Standard laptop task
- Workflow: [Empty field]
- Execution Plan: [Empty field]

Buttons: Copy, Try It, Update, Edit in Catalog Builder, Delete

Related Links

UAT EVIDENCE 5 – Standard Laptop Order Now

ServiceNow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin Standard Laptop Search

Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop Search catalog

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☒ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price \$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually

Quantity 1

Subtotal \$1,100.00

Delivery Order Now 0 Days

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

UAT EVIDENCE 6 – Request / approval

ServiceNow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin Request - REQ0010001 Search

Request - REQ0010001 Discuss Follow Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Approved Task: REQ0010001

Number REQ0010001

Requested for System Administrator

Location

Due date 2026-10-02 08:33:02

Price \$1,100.00

Description

Short description

Special instructions

Opened 2026-10-02 08:33:02

Opened by System Administrator

Approval Requested

Request state Pending Approval

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Requested Items (1) Approvers (1) Recurring Prices (1)

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Approved	Eric Schroeder		2026-10-02 08:33:07

1 to 1 of 1

UAT EVIDENCE 7 – Requested Item → Catalog Tasks

The screenshot shows the 'Requested Item' page for RITM0010001 in the ServiceNow interface. The page includes a 'Comments (Customer visible)' section with a text area and a 'Post' button. Below this is an 'Activities' section showing a single activity by 'System Administrator' with details: Impact 3 - Low, Opened by System Administrator, Priority 4 - Low, and State Open. The 'Update' and 'Delete' buttons are visible. A 'Related Links' section contains a 'Flow Context' link. The 'Catalog Tasks (1)' section is expanded, showing a table with one task: SCTASK0010001, assigned to 'Hardware' with a short description 'Laptop need to Configured'. The table has columns for Number, Assignment group, Assigned to, Short description, Actual start, Actual end, and Order. The URL at the bottom indicates the task is being viewed.

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop need to Configured	2026-10-02 08:33:56	(empty)	

UAT EVIDENCE 8 – Catalog Task details

The screenshot shows the 'Catalog Task' details page for SCTASK0010001. The page includes fields for Number (SCTASK0010001), Assigned to, Configuration item, Active (checked), Approval (Approved), Priority (4 - Low), State (Open), Request item (RITM0010001), and Requested for (System Administrator). The 'Short description' and 'Description' fields both contain 'Laptop need to Configured'. The 'Work notes' field is empty. The 'Activities' section shows a single activity by 'System' with details: Impact 3 - Low, Opened by (Empty), Priority 4 - Low, and State Open. The 'Update', 'Close Task', and 'Delete' buttons are visible. The 'Affected CIs' section is also visible at the bottom.

Impact	Opened by	Priority	State
3 - Low	(Empty)	4 - Low	Open

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

Advantages	Disadvantages / Limitations
Reduces manual task creation	Depends on ServiceNow availability and correct configuration
Routes tasks to Hardware	Administrative maintenance may be required after configuration changes
Improves consistency and visibility	Core implementation does not include external inventory integration
Reusable automation pattern	Approval and catalog configuration must remain correct
Supports traceability from request to task	Actual performance depends on the configured environment

9. CONCLUSION

By automating the Standard Laptop procurement process with ServiceNow Flow Designer, the project addresses manual hand-off inefficiencies. The workflow connects the Service Catalog request and approval process to automatic Catalog Task creation and Hardware assignment, supporting timely configuration and reducing manual overhead.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

- Automatic notifications to requester and Hardware.
- Inventory/asset integration and laptop availability checks.
- SLA monitoring and escalation.
- Procurement status dashboards and analytics.
- Extension to other standard IT equipment catalog items.

11. APPENDIX

Item	Entry
Source Code	Not applicable; configuration is implemented in ServiceNow Flow Designer.
Dataset Link	Not applicable.
GitHub Link	To be added if the team creates a repository.
Project Demo Link	To be added after demonstration is recorded/published.
Screenshot Evidence	Insert actual ServiceNow screenshots in Section 7.1.